

Southern Texas Roost of Hospitality Almanac

2026-2027 Season

TL;DR (Executive Summary)

The Southern Texas Roost of Hospitality (Strohs) exists to put forth four qualifiers for the No Laying Up (NLU) Roost Club Championship event held in late October at Sweetens Cove Golf Course, and to provide at least one player with a chance to participate in the No Laying Up Invitational Tournament (NIT) in November. Wrapped around those two goals is a welcoming community of golfers from all walks of life and a vibrant Discord community where we can find people to play with, talk about architecture and life, and stay connected to each other.

Our five qualifiers will come from:

1. The Texas Two-Step, a two-day 'ringer' tournament.
 - a. The winner of Two Step will also receive our NIT spot
2. The All-Strohs Open (ASO), a one-day quota tournament.
3. The Muni Tour, a season long net-stroke-play points race.
4. OpnSzn, a season-long match-play tournament.

Governing Principles

The Southern Texas Roost of Hospitality, or STROHs will offer a friendly and easily-accessible way for members of the No Laying Up Refuge, and their friends, from Southern Texas and beyond to #getinvolved. We are guided by the following core principles:

Keep the main thing the main thing

We value the hang, meeting new friends, and raising money for charity as much as we value the golf

All are welcome

Come out and play. Seriously. Bring your friends, too.

Don't be a jerk

Assume good intent in all interactions

Competition is important (but this is the 4th principle on purpose)

We know the rules. We keep score. We win with grace, and we lose with grace. "Count shots, hit cups."

What is a Roost?

A Roost is a group of golfers, generally organized geographically, originally organized by people in the message board community of the golf media group No Laying Up (NLU). The message board for NLU was called The Nest (for reasons lost to time), and when they wanted to give some structure to the group events that were happening organically, the Roost term was a fun play on the Nest theme.

We are the Southern Texas Roost of Hospitality (Stroh's). We picked this name for two reasons - first, to mess with Dallas a little bit, and second because the old Strohs Beer logo was sick looking, and easily modified to be shown holding a golf club so it made a great logo. It's possible that we made up the Roost name just to fit Strohs as an acronym.

Roost Club Championship

From the original doc sent out by the NLU crew ([LINK](#)):

This event will be modeled on the Little League World Series. In 2022, there will be 10 Regions across the US, Canada, and the UK/Continental Europe plus a No Laying Up team. Each Region may have numerous clubs (though we may limit the number in year 1 as we figure out our #process). Each region will host a regional tournament to decide the club that represents that region in the championship, and that club will send a team of 4 to the Championship. Regional representatives must be Nest Members to play in the Championship, but local clubs will not be exclusive to Nest members. Regions will be determined by NLU, geography, AND where Nest Members are located. The Championship will be held in Late August or September of 2022 to give each region time to hold their regional tournaments and figure out their club representatives for the Championship.

Thus, our Roost really only exists for one reason - to field a 4-golfer team to compete for a spot in the Roost Club Championship, hosted by NLU at Sweetens Cove Golf Club in Tennessee.. The Strohs are grouped with Big Plex (DFW) and Supercell (Oklahoma) in the Texahoma Region. Our team will play against both in late July or early August for a spot in the Roost Club Championship. Your participation in Stroh's events requires committing to qualifiers to the best of your ability, and possibly the national tournament later in the year.

Separately (but all sort of related), NLU hosts the NLU Invitational (NIT) every November. Each Roost designates one event as its "major." The winner of that event is the NIT qualifier. Our major is the Texas Two-Step event (details below).

Roost Regional Qualifying Events

More detail about each tournament or season-long points race are available in subsequent sections.

1. Texas Two-Step Tournament Winner
2. All-Strohs Open Tournament Winner
3. OpnSzn ("Open Season") Match Play Playoff Bracket Winner
4. Muni Tour Playoff Winner

NLU Invitational Tournament (NIT) Qualifying Event

At the time of this writing, the Texas Two Step tournament (details below) is the Strohs Major. As such, the winner of that event will be the Strohs NIT qualifier.

Roost Regional and NIT Alternates Selection

In case the winner of a qualifying event cannot attend the Roost Regional or Roost National championship, the runner-up for that event shall be the first alternate. Beyond that, the Executive Committee reserves the right to hand-pick our alternates, in order to ensure that we can field a team without undue thrash.

The Executive Committee will make every effort to involve high finishers in the four qualifying events in this selection process. There is usually enough time to ask the runners-up from other events to fill in if both the winner and runner up from a given event cannot go. However, we've had issues in the past by having a fixed alternates list where it took entirely too long to fill out the team because we were bound by the list structure. Our goal is to ensure that the players who have played the best over the course of the year have their chance to represent the Strohs at the national events, but we have to balance that with the fact that everyone has day jobs.

The NIT alternate situation is out of our control. Once our Major completes (currently, Texas Two-Step), we have 7 days to name our qualifier. We do not have to name the winner of the event as our qualifier (for instance, if the winner knows they cannot go to a tournament in November), but once we name a qualifier, we cannot change it. The executive committee will do our best to communicate the dates for the NIT as early as possible in our competition year, so that folks can plan accordingly.

Qualifying Tournament / Event Details

Each of us can go to our local City golf tournament schedule and find one-day and two-day stroke play tournaments. Strohs, as outlined above, is more about #gettinginvolved and enjoying the game, and less about grinding on two footers for double bogey. As such, we will prioritize fun courses, fun formats, and fun side games over pure stroke-play competition.

General Competition Notes

- Teebox Guidance
 - We will aim to play Men from teeboxes 6100-6700 yards
 - Women and those aged 60+ will play from tees targeting 5500-6200 yards.
- Most (if not all) STROHs events will be NET events
 - Match play handicaps will be calculated day of the match (unless otherwise communicated), based on the tees selected by players (split tees OK too)
 - Stroke play tournaments will have handicaps calculated 24 hours before the event by the competition committee, based on assigned tees (see above)
- Hit cups and count all shots. No mulligans, no gimmes except match play.
- All stroke-play events have a 9-shot maximum score (modeled after the Texas UIL golf rules).
- USGA rules govern play. Local course rules overrule USGA rules, and should there be a tournament-specific STROHs rule, those overrule local course rules. In match play, decisions made by agreement of all players in the match override any rule (i.e. even if you get a rule wrong, if all competitors agree, the score is valid).

Stroh's Texas Two-Step (Major)

Texas Two-Step will serve as not only the second Roost Regional team qualifying event, but as the Stroh's major. We invite refugees from other Roosts to join us for the event, and the winner of this event gets the NIT spot. Only a Stroh member can qualify for our Roost Regional team, but anybody can grab that NIT spot (assuming they're a member of the Refuge).

We generally try and run this event in January or February. While that does bring in the risk of bad weather, it makes the tournament slightly more attractive to refugees from northern climates that might be snowed in, and it helps us avoid the crowded spring and summer months. We also try to do the event Friday-Saturday, so that folks can be home on Sunday with their families.

Format

Two Step is a two-day net stroke-play 'ringer' event. Players will take their best score on a given hole from each day to post a single 18-hole ringer score to determine the winner.

For example, on Hole #1, if a player makes a net 5 on day 1, and a net 4 on day 2, their ringer score for Hole #1 is 4. Repeat this process for all holes.

All-STROHs Open

The All-STROHs Open (ASO) is a one-day stroke play quota event. The goal of ASO is to give our Roost a chance to get together, break bread, play a straightforward handicap-friendly format while not requiring an entire weekend of travel (to hopefully make it easy for as many players as possible to attend). The winner of ASO will qualify for Roost Regionals.

For the 2026-2027 season, ASO will move to the Fall in order to free up some space in the spring so we don't have so many things happening in April, May and June on the run-up to Roost Regionals, the Roost Championship, and the NIT (summer and fall).

Format

The ASO will be 18 holes of quota play, with the following scoring pattern

- Double Eagle / Hole in One - 10pts
- Eagle - 8pts
- Birdie - 4pts
- Par - 2pts
- Bogey - 1pt
- Double or worse - 0pts

ASO will institute a minimum quota target of 9 points. Our group is welcoming of high handicap players, and this rule helps us to not have to require negative points for double bogey, which is hell on pace of play.

OpnSzn ("Open Season") Match Play

Format

OpnSzn is a season-long points race competition organized around net-scoring Match Play matches. The OpenSNZ competition is designed around an open-season player pool, which allows all registered STROH's to compete against whoever they choose, wherever they choose, and collect points. At the end of the Regular Season, the Top 12 points scorers will advance to the Playoff Bracket, with the Top 4 players earning a bye into the Quarterfinals.

OpnSzn Dates

Regular Season: September 1st, 2026 until April 12th 2027.

Playoff deadlines (dates here are guidelines, specific deadlines will be communicated in Discord):

- 05/03: First round Playoff Matches complete
- 05/17: Quarterfinal Matches complete
- 06/14: Semifinal Matches complete
- 06/28: Final and Consolation Matches complete

Rules and Scoring

OpnSzn allows for three types of Matches, the winners of which will accumulate points on their season totals - **Singles**, **Fourballs**, and **Alt-Shot**.

Singles:

Traditional H2H Match Play Handicapped off of the low player.

Scoring is:

- 2 points for a win
- 1 point for a draw
- 0 points for a loss

Fourball

Two-player teams playing their own ball in a match against another two-player team, handicapped off the low player in the group. Fourball matches can be played in conjunction with a Singles match, but teammates cannot play each other. Ex. Players A and B challenge Players C and D to a Fourball match to be played in round X. Player A can also play a singles match against Player C and a singles match against Player D in Round X. Player A cannot play a singles match against Player B in Round X

Scoring is:

- 2 points for a win (each player)
- 1 point for a draw (each player)
- 0 points for a loss

Alt-Shot

Two-player teams will play an alternate shot match, handicapped at 50% of each player's handicap (see handicap calculation below).

To incentivize this fun format, we will award all four players who play an alt-shot match 2 points, regardless of the result. This also helps offset the fact that if you're playing alt-shot, you lose the ability to play the two singles matches that you could play if you were playing a regular fourballs match.

Scoring is:

- 7 points for a win (each player on a team)
- 5 points for a draw (each player on a team)
- 3 for a loss (each player on a team)

Alt-shot matches should be played Ryder Cup style, where players decide before the match who will tee off on the odd holes (starting on #1), and who will tee off on the even holes. This order is fixed, and is not affected by who holes the final putt on the previous hole.

Alt-Shot Handicap Calculation

- Player A is a 10
- Player B is an 8
- Their team handicap is thus $(10 \times 0.5) + (8 \times 0.5) = 5 + 4 = 9$.

Posting an OpnSzn Score

Requirements for posting an official Match Play round are:

- Schedule your match directly with your opponent(s)
- Follow all the Rules of Golf for Match Play during the round (no mulligans, etc)
- Fill out the scoring form (available in the Discord)

Muni Tour

Format

The Stroh's Muni Tour is a way to celebrate the strong municipal golf scene that exists throughout Texas, and not just in the major metro areas. The Tour will run from late in the year (we try and start about September) until May of the following year, with participants able to play rounds with other Refugees at their leisure at a select set of municipal golf courses throughout South and Central Texas.

The Muni Tour is divided into three leaderboards, based around the three major metro areas where Strohs members live - San Antonio, Houston, and Austin. Three courses in each metro area are on that city's leaderboard. Players will post net rounds over the course of a season to attempt to place themselves at the top of each leaderboard. The Muni Tour finals will consist of twelve players - the top four finishers from each city. If a player qualifies in the top four in multiple cities, they will officially qualify using their highest positioning, and we will cascade down the leaderboard of any other cities they place in to find a replacement. These twelve players will play on a single day, with the best net score taking the Muni Tour title.

Course List

Austin:

Morris Williams Municipal
Riverside Municipal
Jimmy Clay Municipal

San Antonio:

Brackenridge Park
Cedar Creek Golf Course
Riverside Golf Course

Houston:

Memorial Park Golf Course
Gus Wortham Park
Sharpstown GC

Scoring

There will be a running scoreboard for each course, and for each group of three courses in a city. STROHs members can post one score per course on the Tour. A player must declare their intent to post the score before the first tee shot is played, and only one score may be posted for the purposes of the Muni Tour.

If weather or other acts of god cause the suspension or cancelation of a declared round before the round is finished, the player will be allowed to resume the round that day, or fully restart the round on another day. If the course allows players back out, and the player decides to resume their round, that round counts for the muni tour. The player is not required to resume their round just because the course is allowing players back on (i.e. the time delay lasts too long and player has other commitments). If a life event happens during a round causing a player to need to leave, that round will not count at all.

The Leaderboard for each course will award points to the top 10 net scorers at that course. First place at a course will earn 10 points, down to 1 point for tenth place. Players posting the same net score at a course will split points evenly (so half, third, and quarter points are possible).

The leaderboard for each course can and will change over time, as more rounds are posted. Courses do not have to be played in any specific order.

Running leaderboards for each course, as well as an overall playoff picture leaderboard, will be publicly available. Our goal is to have them on the STROHs group website, but in the short term we will use a google sheet.

Each city leaderboard will be the top aggregate points-scorer across each of the three courses in that city. The city leaderboard is what determines the playoff qualifiers.

Posting an official Muni Tour

- Play with another Refugee (STROHs member preferred but not required)
- Follow all the Rules of Golf during the round (no mulligans, know how to take drops, etc)
- Report the gross score and your course handicap from that day to the scoring coordinator no later than 24 hours after the completion of your round, and note who you played with.

Mulligan Rounds

Even if a player has posted a score at a given course already during the season, they can declare a 'mulligan round' at any Muni Tour course as long as they meet all the requirements for posting a Muni Tour round that day (playing with other Strohs, declare on 1st teebox, etc). If declared, the mulligan round must be counted, and will displace the previously posted score, even if it is a worse score. Players may play as many mulligan rounds as they please.

There are two possible outcomes if a mulligan round is interrupted.

1. If the interruption is an act of god (weather, injury, etc), the round will not count and the original score remains on the leaderboard. The player should make reasonable efforts to return to the course if the course re-opens, but we understand that may not always be possible.
2. If the player decides to leave the round early under their own power (typically because they're playing like poop), the round will count with a score of 100, replacing any prior score.

Muni Tour and OpnSzn Matches

Because our season is long and very distributed, we'll allow a match-play round to count for a Muni Tour score as well, but there are no gimmies for the Muni Tour. A player is required to keep an accurate count and putt all putts out, even if they were "given" during the Match Play portion of the competition.

Muni Tour Championship Playoff

The twelve qualifiers will meet at an agreed upon time, at an agreed upon place, to play 18 holes of net stroke play to crown the Muni Tour season winner, and Roost Regional Playoff qualifier. The competition committee will work to find a location amenable to all participants, factoring in travel time. Our goal is to have the Muni Tour playoff completed by the end of May, to minimize conflicts with summer activities.

Getting Involved

Our goal in Strohs is to provide a few interesting competition scenarios specifically designed to help us all meet more of our Roost counterparts, and clearly and cleanly select our four Roost Regional competitors, as well as identify our NIT qualifier.

We maintain an active Discord community - contact @jdonelson, @omarmjhdpr, or any other Stroh on the refuge (or directly) to get an invite link. The Discord can be overwhelming at first, but it gets easier, I promise. The best place to start would be the #find-a-game channel. It's a rare weekend where someone doesn't have an open spot or two somewhere nearby, and anyone is free to jump in. Just post in that channel and ask if the spot is still available, introduce yourself, and come play golf!

We also keep a group website at <https://www.strohs.club>. It's primarily to keep track of the results from our events, but it'll have a copy of this manifesto, and sometimes some writeups of things we've done. It's worth a bookmark.

Charity

Our Roost will sponsor at least one charity for a season-long donation drive. Roost members are encouraged to find creative ways to maximize our donation to our sponsored charity at the end of the year. Other ideas include running a season-long birdie or eagle challenge for yourself ("I'll donate \$1 for every net birdie I make," etc). We're open to creative ideas!

In previous years, we've donated to the Austin Firefighters Relief and Outreach Fund, as well as to Wonders and Worries. In 2026, we've designated Kids Eat, Inc as the charity of choice. Our charity doesn't change every year, but we're open to new suggestions at any time.